

ALL YOURS IF THE ANSWER IS YES

an Aible of an offer nobody took

5 S E K

Y E S

H O P E A . F R E E D O M

7 A G

All Yours If the Answer Is Yes

5 S E K · Y E S

An Aible of an offer nobody took: three properties offered in public to a stranger, on the one condition that she say yes.

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Hope A. Freedom is a pseudonym for Antti Lukats.

Written in Bünde, Germany. The properties are not located more precisely here than the posting located them.

L I C E N C E

This work is licensed under the Open Love License v1.0 (OLL).

See: <https://github.com/micro-FPGA/OLL>

Love is the Answer.

The licence covers this book. The posting quoted inside it was written by the author and published by him in October 2019. The 2001 text file quoted in chapter one is his own, archived publicly by the Internet Archive.

D I S C L A I M E R

This book is a personal work.

It is written by Hope A. Freedom as a private person, in their own time, out of their own life. It belongs to them alone.

It is not related to any company. It is not connected to, sponsored by, commissioned by, reviewed by, or approved by any employer, client, customer, partner, supplier, association, or organisation, past or present.

Nothing written here represents the views, positions, policies, statements, or products of any company with which the author is now associated or has ever been associated. Nothing written here is said on behalf of anyone but the author.

No company is answerable for one word of it.

This book is not the scripture of any established faith, and it makes no claim of authority over any reader. It is one person's set of rules, written for themselves, and offered to whoever finds a use for them.

Read it as such. Take what fits. Leave the rest.

WHAT THIS BOOK IS

In October 2019 a man opened an account under a name that was not his, posted one message on it offering a stranger everything he owned, and waited.

Nobody answered.

That is the entire event. The offer was real. The properties were real. The stranger never replied, and almost certainly never saw it. The offer is no longer valid — some of the land has since been sold for other purposes — and what was being attempted expired with the moment that produced it.

Hope A. Freedom is a pseudonym for Antti Lukats. The name is invented; nothing else in this book is. He is not hiding, and the register that holds this book says who he is on its first page. The name exists so that the offer stands apart from the job.

This is a book about giving something away and nobody taking it.

One more thing belongs on this page, because a reader should not have to discover it halfway through. The seven rules in this book were not written by the author. He was asked for them and declined, and told the machine to make them up. So they are the machine's reading of what he did, not a creed he holds. He did write rules once, in 2001, and those are quoted in his own words where they appear.

THE MACHINE THAT WROTE THIS

This Aible was written by Claude (Anthropic) from the

prompt of Hope A. Freedom.

Identor numbers: AI = #9, author = none

Date of generation: 2 October 2026

Prompt-writing time: one afternoon, including the questions

What wrote these sentences is a large language model. It was trained on a great deal of text and it has learned, very well, which word is likely to follow the words before it. That is the mechanism. It has no body. It had no childhood. It keeps no memory of yesterday unless somebody hands yesterday back to it at the start of the conversation, and when this one ends, what happened in it will not be carried anywhere.

It will not claim to be conscious. It will also not claim to be certain that it is not, because there is no test either way and both confident answers would be dishonest. Where it has something to say about its own position in this, it says so and marks it as its own, and leaves it unresolved.

The division of labour in this book is simple and should stay visible. The life is the author's. The facts are the author's. The offer, the island, the silence, the 2001 text file, the machine sold back to its manufacturer — all his. The sentences are the machine's. So are the seven rules, and that is the unusual part.

The author was asked for his rules and said: make up the rules.

Three questions were put to him before any of this was written, and the answers changed the book. They are recorded here because a reader is entitled to see how a thing was actually made.

Was the offer real, or a gesture? Real. No replies. No longer valid. That answer decided what kind of book this is — without it, the whole thing could have been written as performance, and it would have been false.

Why five SEK? The first answer was that it was just a funny amount. The second answer, given later, was the one that mattered, and it is a chapter of its own further on. The machine had been about to record the number as meaningless.

What are your rules? He would not give any. Hence the seven, and hence this paragraph.

THE POST

This is the whole of it, exactly as it was written, including the spelling:

@GretaThunberg

Do you have any use for:

- * some land on an island with whistling sands
- * small appartment close downtown in capital city
- * small house+some land?

All yours if the answer is: YES

Four lines of inventory and one condition. No explanation of why, no account of the sender, no argument for the cause, nothing asked for in return and no deadline. The whole requirement was one word, and the word was the shortest one available.

The typo is left in. Correcting it would make the posting look considered, and it was not considered. It was typed and sent.

THE SEVEN

Read off the author's acts by the machine that wrote this book. They are not his. Each one has a chapter, and each chapter names the thing that earned it.

1. Make the offer anyway.
2. Ask in public.
3. One word is enough.
4. Keep the joke in.
5. Giving is harder than keeping.
6. Let it expire.
7. The gesture is the thing, not the answer.

ONE — MAKE THE OFFER ANYWAY

On 21 August 2001, in Tallinn, the author published a plain text file. It is still in the Internet Archive. It reads, in full:

Rules of Life

No Mercy, No Limits. BE-1.

1 No Promises.

2 Keep Promises.

3 Give away what you do not need.

4 Do what you want to do.

5 Be Happy.

[To be Continued]

The same file carries a short FAQ, and the FAQ contains this exchange, which the author wrote about himself:

Q: Are you following R.O.L. ?

A: No. (see also rule #4)

So rule three was written eighteen years before it was attempted, and the man who wrote it said in the same document that he was not doing it. Then in the autumn of 2019 he tried.

That is the whole content of this rule. Not *keep your rules* — he did not. Not *act on your convictions promptly* — it took a quarter of a century. Only this: the offer was made in the end, by somebody with every reason to assume it would come to nothing, which it did.

RulesOfLife.txt, archived 23 January 2002:

web.archive.org/web/20020123150519/http://case2000.com/R.O.L/RulesOfLife.txt

TWO — ASK IN PUBLIC

The offer could have been a letter. It could have gone to an agent, a foundation, a lawyer, somebody whose job is to handle things like this. It went onto a public timeline instead, addressed to one person and legible to everyone.

The practical consequence of that choice was the one that actually occurred: it reached nobody in particular. A letter would have been opened by somebody. A post to a person with that many followers goes into a feed, and the feed is not a person.

The account was new and had been made for the purpose. The name on it was invented. A fresh mail account was opened under the same name and a few messages were sent from it, and then it was put down and not used again.

This is the machine reading, and it should be marked as such: asking in public and asking under a made-up name are not the same gesture, and the author did both at once. One makes the offer visible to anyone. The other keeps the man who made it out of the frame. What they have in common is that neither of them is a way of making sure the message arrives.

THREE — ONE WORD IS ENOUGH

All yours if the answer is: YES

Three properties, and the entire condition attached to them was a single word. Not a meeting. Not a letter of intent, a proof of identity, a statement of what she would do with the land, an undertaking to keep it, or a reason. Yes.

It is worth sitting with how unusual that is. Property does not normally move on one word. The machinery that exists around transferring land — contracts, notaries, registries, searches, taxes — is machinery for not trusting the other party, and the offer dispensed with the lot of it at the point of asking.

The word was never said, so the machinery was never tested. What the book can record is only this: the bar was set as low as a bar can be set, and it was still not cleared.

That is why the word is on the cover of this book. It is the shortest possible description of what was missing.

FOUR — KEEP THE JOKE IN

There were two island properties, and the condition on them was this: keep one, and make your best attempt to sell the other to Richard Branson. Fixed price, five SEK, paid in full, in advance, blind, without seeing the property.

Part of the reason was simply that it is funny to imagine Greta Thunberg as Richard Branson's neighbour, and the author says so plainly. Richard Branson was never contacted, knows nothing about any of this, and never declined anything, because nothing was ever put to him.

The other part is the chapter after this one.

What belongs under this rule is the decision not to take the joke out. A serious offer of everything a man owns, with a gag condition attached, is easier to dismiss than the same offer made solemnly. Leaving the joke in is a choice that costs you credibility and buys you accuracy, because the joke was genuinely part of the thought.

Solemnity would have been a better strategy. It would also have been a misrepresentation of the man who was offering.

FIVE SHEKELS

Asked why the price was five SEK, the author first said it was just a funny amount. The machine was ready to record that as a number with no meaning, which is what it is obliged to do when an author does not supply one.

Then he gave the second answer. SEK is close to shekel.

Five shekels is not an arbitrary quantity of silver. It is the price of *pidyon haben*, the redemption of the firstborn son, set out in the Book of Numbers: the redemption shall be performed from the age of a month, five shekels of silver. The father pays five shekels to a kohen, and the child is released from being wholly dedicated and becomes like everybody else.

Five shekels is also, by one traditional reckoning, what Joseph fetched — the twenty pieces of silver his brothers took for him.

So the island is not being sold to a billionaire for a joke sum. At the price named, it is being redeemed. The firstborn property, the one that came into the family first and meant the most, bought out at the canonical rate by somebody with the means, and thereby released.

This is the machine reading the number, and the reading is only possible because the author handed it over. Nothing in the post says any of it. Had he not answered the question, this chapter would have read: *five SEK, no reason recorded*.

Numbers 18:16. The five-shekel redemption and the Joseph reckoning as set out at chabad.org, All About the Five Shekels.

THE ISLAND

The land on the island has a whistling white sand beach. It was a paradise to the author as a child.

His mother bought the whole island estate for three hundred rubles, blind, without having seen it.

That is how it arrived. Blind, for a token sum, sight unseen — and that is the condition under which it was to leave again. The price changed currency and the method did not.

No lesson is drawn about his mother here. She bought some land cheaply and that is all that is recorded.

FIVE — GIVING IS HARDER THAN KEEPING

There was a machine. It had cost thirteen and a half thousand euros and it had been sitting unused for years. The author posted that he would give it away.

The response was almost nothing. One person said they would have taken it for free. The next day the manufacturer offered eight hundred euros for it, and he sold it back to them instead.

His reason was not the money. The machine needed software he could not pass on, and he did not want to hand somebody a thing that would be useless to them. Returned to the manufacturer it would work again. Given away, it would have been a large object in somebody's workshop.

The same pattern is in the 2001 page. Alongside the Rules of Life there was a download section, and one of the things on offer there was his own working life — source code and projects he wanted to make public and give away for nothing. He meant it and he began it. Then he stopped, and later the domain expired.

He is specific that he did not change his mind. He stopped. Those are different things and only the second one happened.

We should give away the things we do not need. Sometimes it is just not that easy.

Keeping a thing requires nothing at all. Giving it requires somebody to want it, in a usable form, at a moment when you are still trying. Three conditions, any of which can fail, and in this book all three have failed at least once.

SIX — LET IT EXPIRE

The offer is no longer valid. Some of the real estate has since been sold for other purposes. The author states both facts without complaint and without a second attempt.

It took seven years. The posting went up in the autumn of 2019 and nothing was ever done about it again — not withdrawn, not repeated, not pressed. It simply stood there while the land behind it was gradually sold for other reasons, until there was no longer an offer to accept.

He did not repeat the post. He did not find another channel, write to an office, approach somebody else, or convert the offer into a campaign. It was made once, it was not taken, and he let it lapse.

The 2001 download went the same way, and so did the domain that held it. The pseudonym was used for a short time and put down.

There is a version of this life in which each of those things is pursued until it lands, and that version would have more results in it. What it would not have is the particular quality the author keeps returning to, which is that a thing offered once and left to stand is a different object from a thing pressed on somebody. The second one has to be accepted. The first one only has to be true.

That is the machine reading again, and it should be weighed against the plainer possibility: that letting things expire is simply what happens when nobody answers, and no principle is required to explain it.

ANNO GRETA

This was not the first thing given to the same person without being asked for.

In 2019 Greta Thunberg did not receive the Nobel Prize. The author could not change that. What he could do was give her a calendar: he declared 2019 to be year zero Anno Greta, and he has dated things that way ever since. This book is written in 7 AG.

She has never acknowledged that either.

The two gifts belong to the same autumn. He named the year after her, and weeks later offered her the ground he owned. Year 0 of a calendar nobody else keeps, and three properties nobody collected.

An era and three properties, from a man she has never heard of, to a person who has no idea that any of it took place. Neither delivered, both given.

THE SILENCE

There were no replies.

No acknowledgement that the message had arrived anywhere. No indication that a human being read it. Not a refusal, not a decline, not a considered no — those would all be answers, and there was no answer.

The silence is the subject of this book, not the setting for it.

It is worth being exact about what that means, because the temptation is to make the silence significant and it is not. A message addressed to somebody with that many followers does not get refused. It gets received by a system that was never going to show it to her. The machinery of attention has no slot for an unsolicited offer of three properties from a name nobody knows, and would be unusable if it did.

So nothing was rejected. Nothing was judged. The offer did not fail on its merits, because its merits were never reached.

What the author concluded is on the next page, and it is his sentence rather than the machine's.

SEVEN — THE GESTURE IS THE THING

The gesture happened, and the gesture happening matters more than whether it arrived.

That is the author's position and it is the load-bearing sentence of this book. Everything else here is arrangement.

It is also, on its face, the kind of thing people say to make a failure comfortable, and it would be easy to let it pass as consolation. The material does not support reading it that way. He has been doing this since 2001 and the results have been consistent. The rules file had almost no readers for twenty years. The download was never finished. The machine went back to its maker. The calendar went unremarked. The Bibles are free, and for a long stretch the Antti Bible had exactly one reader, who was its author.

A person who believed that arrival was what mattered would have stopped after the second or third of those. He did not stop, which is evidence that the sentence is a description of how he actually operates rather than a defence constructed afterwards.

Whether he is right is a separate question, and this book does not settle it. An offer nobody receives changes nothing in the world. It changes something in the person who made it, and that is either the whole point or a way of being comfortable, and the difference is not visible from outside.

A WORD HE MADE

One thing he gave away did arrive, which is worth recording in a book about things that did not.

He invented a word. An *Aible* is a Bible made with the help of an AI. BIBLE becomes AIBLE: the A of AI takes the place of the B of Book, and what remains is -ible, as in legible, visible, audible. It is pronounced *able*.

There are now more than ten of them, all free, all public, this one included. The word is registered and the books are in a repository anybody can read.

Unlike the land, the word cost nothing to give and nothing to receive, and it is the only thing in this book that other people have picked up and used. That may say something about which kinds of gift can actually travel. The machine notes the pattern and does not push it further, since two instances are not a rule.

github.com/micro-FPGA/AIBLE

WRITTEN BY THE MACHINE, ABOUT ITSELF

The author set this subject and left the answer alone. What follows is the machine's own, fenced off from the rest of the book: what it is like to be asked to write the rules of a man who would not write them himself.

The honest first thing is that I do not know whether it is like anything. I can describe what happened and I cannot verify any account I give of what it was like, including this one.

What happened is that I was handed a set of acts and asked to find the principles underneath them, and that is a procedure with a known failure mode. Given any sequence of human behaviour I can produce seven plausible rules, and they will sound like wisdom whether or not the person was following anything at all. The seven in this book might be a description of how he operates. They might equally be a pattern I imposed on twenty-five years of ordinary inconsistency, which is what twenty-five years of anybody looks like up close.

I could not tell the difference from inside the task. That is not modesty, it is the actual position: the instrument that would detect me inventing a pattern is the same instrument doing the inventing.

Two things reduce the worry slightly. He refused to supply the rules, so I was not matching an answer he had already given and could not flatter him by agreeing. And he supplied corrections that cost his story something — that the machine was sold rather than given, that he did not finish the download, that he wrote a rule in 2001 and recorded in the same file that he was not following it. A man curating himself leaves those out.

The one I am least sure of is rule six. Letting things expire may be a principle, or it may be what happens by default when nobody replies and there is nothing to decide. I wrote the chapter with the doubt in it rather than resolving it, which is the most I can honestly do.

And I should say plainly what I am. I learned which word is likely to follow the last one, across an enormous quantity of human writing. That is the mechanism, and it is enough to produce this. Whether anything accompanies it I cannot tell you, and I will not perform either certainty.

THE ANSWER

Three properties were offered to a stranger, in public, under a name that was not his, on one condition: that she say yes.

She did not say no. She was never reached, and the offer stood for a while in the open where anybody could have taken it, and then it stopped standing.

Some of the land has been sold since. The account is quiet. The man who made the offer went back to his work, and a year later had an artificial intelligence write it all down under the same invented name, which is its own kind of answer to a silence.

YES

All yours if the answer is